

Burak Kalafat

Senior Backend Engineer | .NET | Banking & Payments

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Istanbul, Turkey | Europe/Istanbul

Summary

Hands-on software engineer with 14+ years in banking, payments and enterprise financial software. Modernises COBOL/mainframe systems into .NET and Java backends, including EOD and batch workloads. Combines implementation, architecture decisions and technical leadership with enterprise Copilot engineering and reusable AI-assisted development workflows. International remote experience; targeting UK/EU relocation and EMEA remote opportunities, including visa-sponsored roles.

Professional Experience

Senior Software Engineer (Backend, .NET) | Innovance

May 2024 – Present | Istanbul, Turkey (Remote)

- Modernise Akbank payment and banking systems from COBOL/mainframe to C#/.NET and Java, analysing legacy business rules and making backend architecture decisions.
- Work on mission-critical EOD and batch modernisation, analysing job dependencies and workload orchestration for scheduled banking processes.
- Designed and developed an enterprise GitHub Copilot plugin for the Architecture organisation, packaging reusable guidance, agent/sub-agent workflows and engineering standards.
- Built repository- and database-oriented Copilot workflows and reusable engineering knowledge to support AI-assisted SDLC and spec-driven development across teams.
- Built internet and mobile banking backends for Türkiye Finans using ASP.NET MVC, WCF, SQL Server and unit tests.

Senior Software Engineer (Backend, .NET) | insightsoftware

September 2022 – April 2024 | North Carolina, USA (Remote)

- Developed C#/.NET Core backend features for enterprise financial software, contributing to architecture and technical design.
- Collaborated with an international remote engineering team on backend design and delivery.

Senior Software Engineer (Backend, .NET) | OBSS

September 2017 – September 2022 | Istanbul, Turkey

- Led Halkbank mobile banking backend migration from .NET Framework to .NET Core and Clean Architecture.
- Applied asynchronous programming and thread optimisation to banking request handling; built REST APIs with EF Core and SQL Server.
- Used Repository/Unit of Work patterns and Azure DevOps CI/CD pipelines for backend delivery.
- Owned code reviews and mentored Türkiye Finans developers, establishing coding standards for WinForms and WCF applications.
- Led Akbank payment campaign development with C#, Java/Spring, TypeScript, Knockout.js and Oracle 12c.

Professional Experience · Continued

Java Developer | TÜBİTAK

January 2017 – September 2017 | Kocaeli, Turkey

- Built Java software to write EAC/SAC security data to passport smartcard chips using APDU commands for government identification systems.

.NET Developer | VakıfBank

August 2013 – January 2017 | Istanbul, Turkey

- Modernised VakıfBank CRM and collections applications towards service-oriented architecture with WPF/MVVM, WCF, Oracle 11g and PL/SQL.

Part-Time .NET Developer | VeriPark

December 2012 – June 2013 | Izmir, Turkey

- Built ASP.NET widgets for Turkcell’s SharePoint environment while completing the Computer Engineering degree.

Technical Skills

Banking and Modernisation

Payment systems, COBOL/mainframe modernisation, End-of-Day (EOD), Batch processing, Job dependencies, Workload orchestration

Architecture and Design

Clean Architecture, Domain-Driven Design (DDD), Distributed systems, Service-oriented architecture, Repository, Unit of Work, Facade, Strategy

Enterprise AI Engineering

GitHub Copilot Enterprise, AI-assisted SDLC, Agentic development, Spec-Driven Development (SDD), Developer enablement, Architecture enablement

Technical Leadership and Quality

Architecture guidance, Code reviews, Mentoring, Coding standards, Unit testing, Playwright E2E testing

Training

Microservices, .NET with AWS, React

Backend Engineering

C#, .NET, .NET Core, ASP.NET MVC, REST APIs, EF Core, Asynchronous programming, WCF

Data and Integration

Oracle, SQL Server (MSSQL), PL/SQL, IBM MQ, RabbitMQ

Delivery and Platforms

Azure DevOps, GitHub Actions, CI/CD, Docker, Kubernetes

Languages and Frameworks

Java, Spring, TypeScript, JavaScript, WPF, WinForms, Knockout.js

Education

BSc in Computer Engineering · Ege University

Izmir, Turkey | September 2008 – June 2013

Certifications

Microsoft Certified: Azure AI Engineer Associate

Microsoft | Certification | March 6, 2026 | Expires March 6, 2027 | Certification overview (AI-102)

Introduction to GitHub Copilot

Microsoft Learn | Training | 2024 | Course overview

Build Microservices with .NET and Amazon Web Services · Udemy | Training | February 2024

IELTS - Band 7 · British Council | Language test | 2023

React Nanodegree Program · Udacity | Training | February 2020

Languages · Turkish: Native; English: Professional proficiency; IELTS Band 7 (2023)

Interests · Chess; LLM and RAG applications; AI-powered customer service; Travel and cultural exchange